with common rights and status and uniform scales of pay throughout the country. All the three All-India Services are Class-I (Group-A) Services.

The All-India Services have three categories. They are:

- Super time scale
- Senior scale
- Junior scale

In the beginning, the officers are appointed in the junior scale. In the course of time, they are placed in the senior scale and the super time scale.

The three All-India Services are managed and controlled by three different Ministries of the Central Government. They are:

- IAS by the Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions
- IPS by the Ministry of Home Affairs
- IFoS by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change

It must be mentioned here that the All-India Services are controlled jointly by the Central and state governments. The ultimate control lies with the Central Government while the immediate control vests with the state governments. Their salaries and pensions are met by the states. However, the disciplinary action (imposition of penalties) against these officers can only be taken by the Central government.

Presently, there are twenty-six state cadres in all for the All-India Services. This includes two joint cadres — (i) Assam-Meghalaya and (ii) Arunachal Pradesh, Goa, Mizoram and the Union Territories (AGMUT).



**Central Services**

The personnel of Central Services work under the exclusive jurisdiction of the Central Government. They man specialised (functional and technical) positions in various departments of the Central Government. Most of them are controlled and managed by their respective ministries/departments, while a few of them are controlled and managed by the Ministry of Personnel. It (Ministry of Personnel) also determines the general policies pertaining to all the Central Services. In fact, the Ministry of Personnel is the central personnel agency in the Government of India.

Before independence, the Central Services were classified into Class I, Class II, Subordinate and Inferior services. After independence, the nomenclature of Subordinate and Inferior Services was replaced by Class III and Class IV Services on the recommendation of the First Pay Commission (1946–1947). Again in 1974, the classification of Central Services into Class I, Class II, Class III and Class IV was changed to Group A, Group B, Group C and Group D, respectively. This was done on the recommendation of the Third Pay Commission (1970–1973). Thus, as of now, the Central Services are classified into four categories. They are:

- Central Services, Group A